Girls Build Bots — Brownie Cybersecurity Investigator

Badge-aligned workshop guide for robotics-team-led outreach

Level: Brownies (Grades 2–3) · **Badge:** Cybersecurity — Cybersecurity Investigator **Series:** Cybersecurity (Basics · Safeguards · Investigator) **Format:** One 75–90 minute session · **Ratio:** 1 mentor per 3–4 Scouts **Who runs it:** A FIRST robotics team (FLL / FTC / FRC) leading the session. A physical robot is a nice bonus but **not required** — every activity runs on simple printed props the team or troop can provide.

> **Troop Leaders:** This curriculum is designed to *align with* the Brownie Cybersecurity badge series. Official badge requirements are in your Girl Scout Volunteer Toolkit (VTK). Verify completed activities against the official steps before awarding badges. Badges are purchased through your council shop.

The through-line: being safe and smart online

The Cybersecurity series builds digital street-smarts: understand how information travels (Basics), protect it (Safeguards), and **think critically to solve problems** (Investigator). Keep it concrete and friendly — never scary.

Vocabulary: investigate, clue, evidence, real vs. fake, trustworthy, think critically.

Cybersecurity Investigator (75–90 minutes)

Badge theme: Playing detective — spotting clues, thinking critically about what we see online, and investigating like cyber sleuths.

Materials

- Printed “message” cards: some real-looking and safe, some obvious fakes (“You won a FREE puppy, click here!!!”)
- A simple “spot the difference” pair (a real-looking logo vs. a slightly-off fake)
- Magnifying glasses (optional but Brownies love them), detective “badge” stickers

Activity 1 — Detectives Look for Clues (15 min)

Cyber investigators are detectives — they look closely and ask questions before they trust something. Warm up with a quick “spot the difference” between a real thing and a fake, so Scouts practice noticing small details.

Activity 2 — Real or Fake? (25 min)

Show message cards one at a time. For each, Scouts hunt for **clues**: Too-good-to-be-true prizes? Lots of !!!? Spelling mistakes? Asking for personal information? They vote real or fake and explain their clue. **The skill: don't trust automatically — investigate first.**

Activity 3 — Crack the Case (25 min)

A friendly staged mystery: "Someone got a message saying they won a prize — should they click it?" In small teams, Scouts examine 2–3 clue cards (the message, a fake sender, a suspicious link drawn on paper) and decide together: safe or trick? Then present their verdict and the clue that gave it away.

Activity 4 — Investigator Oath (5 min) + Wrap (5 min)

Each Scout finishes: "Before I trust something online, I will ___." (Look for clues / ask a grown-up / check if it's too good to be true.) Hand out detective badge stickers.

> **Robot moment (optional):** Share for 60 seconds how the team investigates when the robot misbehaves — looking for clues in the code to find the real problem, just like a cyber detective.

Completion Checklist — Cybersecurity Investigator

By the end of the session, to earn the badge, each Scout can: - [ ] Explain that a cyber investigator looks for clues before trusting something - [ ] Spot clues that a message might be fake (too-good-to-be-true, misspellings, asking for private info) - [ ] Work with a team to decide if something is safe or a trick - [ ] Name one thing she'll do before trusting something online

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Mentor Guide (for the robotics team)

- **You don't need a robot for this.** Printed clue cards are the whole activity. The "robot moment" box is optional.
- **Make the fakes obvious for Brownies.** Exaggerated fakes (ALL CAPS, "FREE!!!", puppy prizes) are easiest to learn from — subtlety comes at older levels.
- **Praise the reasoning, not just the answer.** "What clue told you?" matters more than right/wrong.
- **Keep it playful.** Detective framing, magnifiers, stickers — it should feel like a game, not a warning.
- **Watch the clock.** Brownies fade after ~25 minutes; keep segments moving.

📣 Share Your Impact — required for teams and troops using this curriculum

If you use Girls Build Bots materials to run a workshop, please complete all three:

1. **Credit us.** Tell your Scouts and audience that the curriculum comes from Girls Build Bots, and credit "Girls Build Bots" anywhere you share about the event.
2. **Tag us.** Post about your workshop and tag **@girlsbuildbots** on Instagram.
3. **Report your results.** Email **girlsbuildbots@gmail.com** with: the number of girls who participated, the number of badges earned, and a sentence or two of feedback on how it went.

This is how the program grows and how we measure our impact — your report becomes part of the Girls Build Bots story and helps the next troop and team.

Created for the "Girls Build Bots" Girl Scout Gold Award project. Original curriculum aligned to the Brownie Cybersecurity badge series; official requirements © Girl Scouts of the USA, available to troop leaders in the Volunteer Toolkit.